

sports OLYMPIC CONTENDERS

■ By Sharda Ugra

Listen to them. Something's not right. When Akhil Kumar, bantamweight boxer, says "if I win a medal...", he contemplates the idea not with a dreamy, faraway look in his eyes, but just like he ordered cold coffee, business-like, matter-of-fact-like. Badminton player Saina Nehwal, 18, is wide-eyed about the Olympics but that's because she's really keen to catch a glimpse of her draw. "I believe," she says with teenage certainty, "that dreams come true." Rifle shooter Gagan Narang, the first to qualify for the 2008 Olympics, knows where he stands, "People know that they need to watch out for me since I am shooting in three events." Mangal Singh Champia is rotund, swarthy, a little shy, for all purposes the same boy who went chas-

MEDAL QUEST: (From left) Sandhu, Champia, Kumar and Nehwal



CHAMP

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